SECRET NO. 1 · SCALES

TOP SECRET

Seven white keys, seven scales

YOUR MISSION

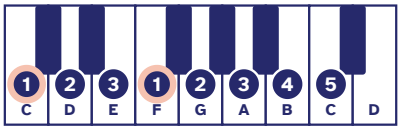
Play a major scale from **every white key**, C D E F G A B, with the **right hand**.

Why this order? Along the keyboard, one key at a time: you always know which scale comes next. Every major scale has the same steps, so only the **black keys** change.

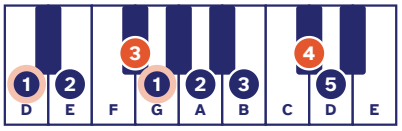
Try it: play all seven, right hand, slowly

(red = black key · the number is the finger · ringed = thumb)

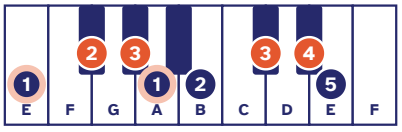
C major
no black keys



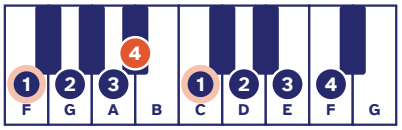
D major
2 black keys: F♯ C♯



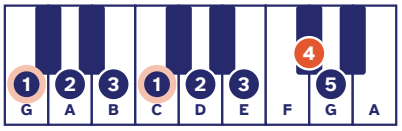
E major
4: F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯



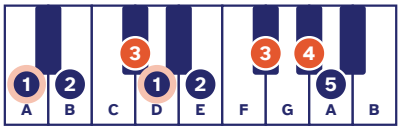
F major
1: B♭



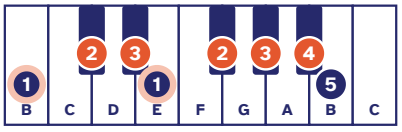
G major
1: F♯



A major
3: F♯ C♯ G♯



B major
5: F♯ C♯ D♯ G♯ A♯



DETECTIVE QUESTION

Six of the seven scales use **the same finger numbers**. Which one is different? And in that one, where would the thumb have landed?

don't turn the page yet!

For teachers and parents: let them play all seven before saying anything. The odd one out is on the next page: it sticks when they find it first.

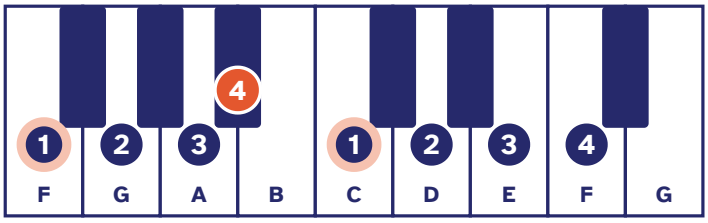
SECRET NO. 1 · REVEALED

REVEALED

Same fingers, except F

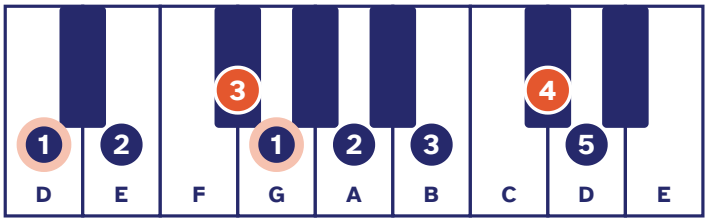
1 2 3 · 1 2 3 4 5 for C, D, E, G, A and B. The thumb tucks under after finger 3. **F major** is the one that changes: **1 2 3 4 · 1 2 3 4**.

Why: the thumb stays on white keys



In F major the 4th note is B♭, a black key.

With the usual fingers the thumb would land on it. So finger 4 plays B♭, and the thumb tucks under one note later, onto C. The thumb always looks for a white key.



Everywhere else the thumb plays notes 1 and 4.

In D major that is D and G: both white. The black keys fall under fingers 2, 3 or 4, where the long fingers reach easily.

Your seven, right hand

C	D	E	F	G	A	B
○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○
			1 2 3 4 · 1 2 3 4			

One circle each time a scale is clean: slow, even, and without stopping.

NEXT SECRET

Now the **left hand**. Same seven scales, and its own odd one out: Secret No. 2.

1 **Secret No. 1 unlocked.** In your Workbook: tick each scale when it is clean at a slow, even speed.

SECRET NO. 2 · SCALES

TOP SECRET

The left hand's turn

YOUR MISSION

Play the same **seven** scales with the **left hand**.

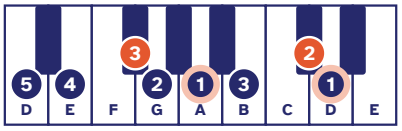
Why this order? The right hand already knows these keys, so the left hand only has to learn its fingers. And most of them are the right hand **in a mirror**.

Try it: play all seven, left hand, slowly *(start on finger 5, the little finger, and climb)*

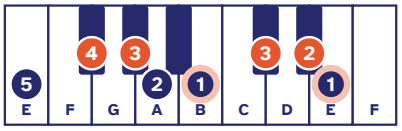
C major
no black keys



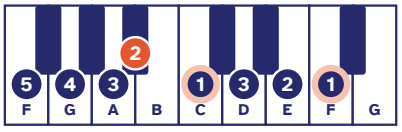
D major
2 black keys: F♯ C♯



E major
4: F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯



F major
1: B♭



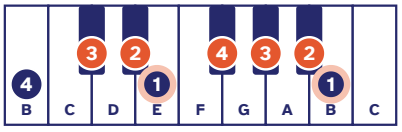
G major
1: F♯



A major
3: F♯ C♯ G♯



B major
5: F♯ C♯ D♯ G♯ A♯



DETECTIVE QUESTION

Read the left hand's numbers **backwards**, from the top note down. What do you notice? Which scale is the odd one out this time, and is it the same one as for the right hand?

don't turn the page yet!

For teachers and parents: ask them to say the right-hand numbers while looking at the left-hand picture. The mirror is easier to hear than to see.

SECRET NO. 2 · REVEALED

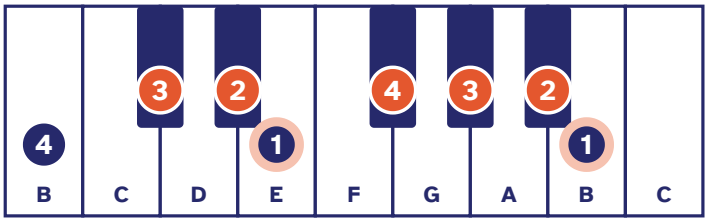
REVEALED

A mirror, except B

Left hand: **5 4 3 2 1 · 3 2 1** for C, D, E, F, G and A. From the top it reads 1 2 3 · 1 2 3 4 5: the right hand in a mirror.

B major is the one that changes: **4 3 2 1 · 4 3 2 1**.

Why: the thumb stays on white keys, again



In B major the 5th note is F♯, a black key.

The usual left hand puts the thumb there. So the left hand starts on finger 4, and its thumbs land on **E** and **B**: white keys.

Right hand
F is different

Left hand
B is different

Hands together

Thumbs do not land together. Going up, the right thumb tucks under after note 3; the left thumb plays note 5 and finger 3 crosses over it. That is why hands together feels wobbly at first.

Practise the join alone: notes 3 4 5 of the scale, both hands, five times. Then the whole scale.

Your seven, left hand

C	D	E	F	G	A	B
○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○ 4 3 2 1 · 4 3 2 1

One circle each time a scale is clean: slow, even, and without stopping.

NEXT SECRET

Next, the **circle**: why some scales get sharps and some get flats, and why every white-key scale except F is a sharp key.

2 **Secret No. 2 unlocked.** Hands separately first, then the join, then together.

SECRET NO. 3 · SCALES

TOP SECRET

Where do your seven live?

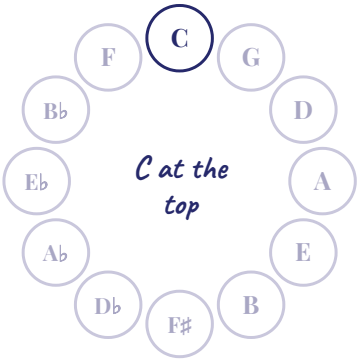
YOUR MISSION

Find your seven white-key scales on the **circle of fifths**, and see why some get sharps and one gets a flat.

Why this order? You already play all seven. Now the circle tells you **before you play** how many black keys a scale will need, for every key on the piano.

SCALE	ITS BLACK KEYS	HOW MANY?
C major	none	☐
D major	F♯ C♯	☐
E major	F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯	☐
F major	B♭	☐
G major	F♯	☐
A major	F♯ C♯ G♯	☐
B major	F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯ A♯	☐

Count the black keys you played in Secrets 1 and 2 and write the number.



Try it: on the circle, colour every scale with sharps red and every scale with flats blue.
(or turn the Scale finder in the app)

DETECTIVE QUESTION

Which side of the circle are the red ones on? Read them clockwise from C: does the number of sharps go up one at a time? And which white-key scale is all alone on the other side?

don't turn the page yet!

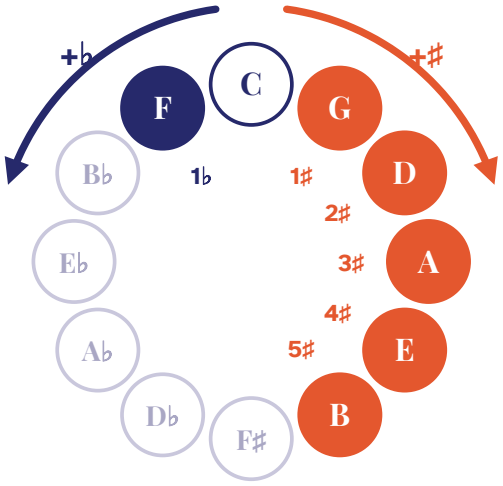
For teachers and parents: let them colour first, with the app's Scale finder open if you have it: right is ♯, left is ♭. Say nothing about F until they spot it.

SECRET NO. 3 · REVEALED

REVEALED

Right for sharps, left for flats

Clockwise from C, each step adds **one sharp**: G 1, D 2, A 3, E 4, B 5. One step anticlockwise adds **one flat**: F. So every white-key major is a sharp key **except F**.



The new sharp is always note 7

KEY	SHARPS	THE NEW ONE
G	F♯	**F♯** = note 7 of G
D	F♯ C♯	**C♯** = note 7 of D
A	F♯ C♯ G♯	**G♯** = note 7 of A
E	F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯	**D♯** = note 7 of E
B	F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯ A♯	**A♯** = note 7 of B

Each step keeps the old sharps and adds one more: the note just below the new key note.

F, the odd one out, twice over

On the circle
the only flat white key

Under the right hand
1 2 3 4 · 1 2 3 4

The same B♭ that makes F the flat key also moves the right-hand thumb (Secret No. 1).

NEXT SECRET

The rest of the left side of the circle is the **black-key family**. Next we play them in keyboard order: the keys of the **two black keys** first, then the **three**.

3 **Secret No. 3 unlocked.** In your Workbook: colour your own circle, and write the number of sharps or flats in each key.

SECRET NO. 4 · SCALES

TOP SECRET

The black-key family

YOUR MISSION

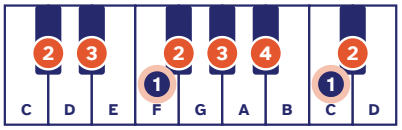
Play the five major scales that start on a **black key**, in keyboard order: the group of **two** black keys first, then the group of **three**.

Why this order? Along the keyboard again, so you always know which comes next. They are all on the **flat side** of the circle, and one rule decides every finger.

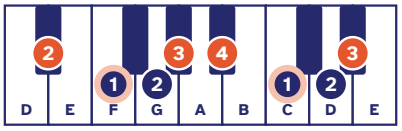
Try it: right hand, slowly *(red = black key · ringed = thumb)*

On the group of two black keys

D♭ major
5 flats

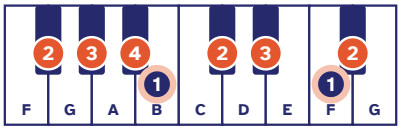


E♭ major
3 flats

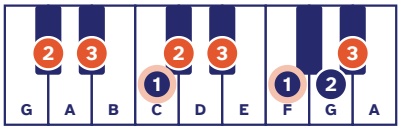


On the group of three black keys

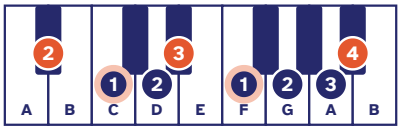
G♭ major
6 flats



A♭ major
4 flats



B♭ major
2 flats



DETECTIVE QUESTION

Look at the **ringed** thumbs in all five. What colour are the keys the thumb plays? Which two white keys does it land on most? And which finger starts every scale?

don't turn the page yet!

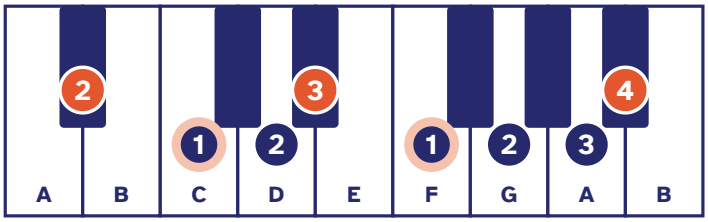
For teachers and parents: these fingerings are the ones in the app's Scale finder; open it on each key and play along. Let them find the thumb rule before you say it.

SECRET NO. 4 · REVEALED

REVEALED

Thumbs only on white keys

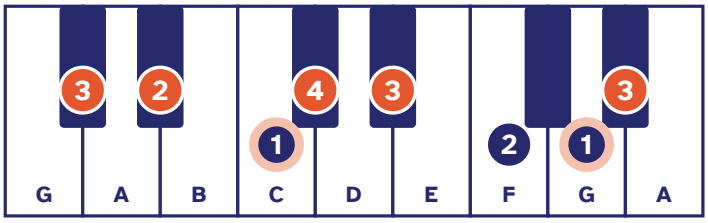
In every black-key scale the thumb plays **white keys only**, nearly always **C** and **F**. So the right hand starts on **finger 2**, and the scale shows you where the thumb fits.



B♭ major: thumbs on C and F.

Finger 2 on B♭, thumb on C, and again 1 on F. In D♭, A♭ and E♭ the thumbs land on the same two white keys. In G♭ the thumb plays C♭ (the white key B) and F.

The left hand: one pattern for four of them



3 2 1 · 4 3 2 1 · 3

The same in D♭, E♭, A♭ and B♭. Only G♭ changes: **4 3 2 1 · 3 2 1 · 2**.

Your five, both hands

D♭	E♭	G♭	A♭	B♭
○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○	○○○
RH 2 3 1 2 …	RH 2 1 2 3 …	RH 2 3 4 1 …	RH 2 3 1 2 …	RH 2 1 2 3 …

One circle each time it is clean, hands separately, then together.

NEXT SECRET

Now you have all twelve. Next: play them **one after another, up by semitones**, C, D♭, D, E♭ … B, hands together.

4 **Secret No. 4 unlocked.** Colour the flat side of your circle: F, B♭, E♭, A♭, D♭, G♭.